

Social Housing Deadlines Reshaping UK Energy Demand

Four deadlines that can't move, and one scheme that excludes you.

The real, dated regulatory picture — in order.

30 Nov 2026

Excess cold AND excess heat both become legal hazards — same law, same day.

Awaab's Law Phase 2 adds seven hazard categories at once, including cold and heat together — not as separate milestones. From this date, under-heating a storage-heated home is a compliance exposure, not a comfort issue.

 **Overheating guidance is almost entirely about insulation and ventilation, not mechanical cooling. The heat half is the easier one to miss — it's the same deadline, not a later one.**

31 Mar 2028

The grant money has to be spent — earlier than the funding window sounds.

The Warm Homes: Social Housing Fund's Wave 3 allocation — £1.29bn across 144 projects — has a real spend deadline: all grant funding by 31 March 2028, with co-funding only in the delivery window's final six months (to Sept 2028).

Neither heat pumps nor storage-heater upgrades are named as their own distinct eligible category in what's publicly published. Confirm what your measures actually qualify as.

2030 & 2039

The big one has two dates inside it — and the first has an open question.

MEES runs in two stages — first metric by 1 April 2030, second by 1 April 2039. Each stage: pick one of three routes (Fabric Performance, Smart Readiness, Heating System), each with a £10,000 spend cap.

 **“Smart Readiness” isn’t technically defined yet. The consultation’s own modelling named solar PV, batteries and smart meters — not storage-heater controls.**

Ongoing

The Boiler Upgrade Scheme sounds like an answer. It isn't one for you.

BUS was extended to 2030 in its April 2026 refresh, adding a new £2,500 air-to-air grant alongside the existing £7,500 air-to-water grant.

Scheme guidance is explicit: “not open to social housing providers.” Not technology-specific — it's a policy choice, which means it's reversible.

PUTTING IT IN ORDER

- 30 Nov 2026 Excess cold AND excess heat both become legal hazards
- 31 Mar 2028 WH:SHF Wave 3 grant-spending deadline (delivery to Sept 2028)
- 1 Apr 2030 MEES first metric — Smart Readiness route still undefined
- 1 Apr 2039 MEES second metric due
- Ongoing BUS excludes social housing outright, any heat pump type

None of these dates move because the technology or funding picture is uncertain.

Planning around these now beats finding out in 2029 which route you were actually eligible for.

Full write-up with sourcing, the open Smart Readiness question, and what it means for demand-side energy patterns — [link in the post](#).

Part of the same project behind the carbon, cost, and policy series.